

Week 1, Lesson 1: What Drives People to Seek Adventure?

Detailed 60-minute lesson plan | Ignite English pp. 10-11 | 6SI / KS3-aligned

60 minutes

Core text: Ignite pp. 10-11

Unit launch

Lesson Purpose

Launch the unit by establishing a rich, flexible idea of adventure. Students use the opener image and Mick Conefrey interview to explore risk, uncertainty, exploration and motivation, then build an initial unit vocabulary bank. The lesson deliberately moves from personal experience to textual evidence and finally to a short analytical paragraph.

Essential Question

What drives people to seek out adventure?

Core Lesson Outcome

Students explain why people seek adventure, using evidence, examples and increasingly precise vocabulary.

Learning Objectives & Success Criteria

- Identify and explain characteristics commonly associated with adventure.
- Retrieve and infer information from the unit introduction and Mick Conefrey interview.
- Express and justify an opinion about why people choose adventurous experiences.
- Use precise vocabulary to discuss adventure.

Expected	Greater depth
• Give at least 3 features of adventure. • Identify 2+ motives for seeking adventure. • Support an idea with evidence/example. • Use 3+ new adventure words.	• Distinguish physical from psychological/emotional adventure. • Explain why the same activity can feel different to different people. • Challenge the idea that adventure must involve physical danger.

British Curriculum Alignment (KS3 / Year 7)

- Reading: understand increasingly challenging texts; infer meaning and refer to evidence; consider how language and context shape meaning.
- Spoken English: participate constructively in discussion, build on others' ideas, present viewpoints clearly and justify them.
- Vocabulary & Writing: acquire a wide vocabulary, use Standard English confidently and make precise choices for purpose and audience.

Detailed Lesson Sequence

Time	Phase	Teacher Actions	Student Actions	Assessment / Evidence
0-5	Do Now What is adventure?	Display only ADVENTURE. Students write five words/phrases they associate with it. Keep this silent at first so ideas are genuinely individual.	Write five associations, then circle the one they think is most important.	Circulate. Note existing vocabulary and whether students equate adventure only with danger.
5-12	Image inference	Reveal the p.10 opener. Ask: What can you see? What connects these images? What idea about adventure is being presented? Push observation into inference.	Think-pair-share. Use visual evidence to infer ideas such as risk, exploration, uncertainty, challenge and freedom.	Cold-call. Require the stem: I think... because...
12-17	Essential question	Reveal: What drives people to seek out adventure? Collect responses and organise them into broad motives on the board.	Suggest motives and refine class categories.	Listen for causal reasoning, not just lists.
17-25	Read the introduction	Read the introduction on p.11. Ask students to identify words and ideas connected with adventure. Clarify unknown, thrill, experience, explore as needed.	Read and annotate. Highlight language that helps define adventure.	Retrieval questions and quick checks for vocabulary.
25-32	Mick Conefrey interview	Read the interview. Ask: 1) What does Conefrey enjoy about adventure? 2) Can adventure be experienced indirectly? 3) What can adventure stories reveal about people?	Answer orally, then write concise responses in complete sentences.	Check distinction between explicit information and inference.
32-40	Personal adventure	Use Activity 1: What is the most adventurous thing you have ever done? Model event + why it felt adventurous rather than a bare anecdote.	Pair discussion, then prepare a 30-second response. Selected students share.	Assess clarity, explanation and justification in speech.
40-47	Motivation & emotion	Use Activity 2: feelings before, during and after. Then return to: Why do people seek adventure?	Discuss emotional trajectory and motives. Add precise words to class list.	Probe with why?, so what? and what makes you say that?
47-54	Vocabulary wall	Begin the unit vocabulary wall. Upgrade vague choices: scary -> daunting, fun -> exhilarating, hard -> challenging.	Suggest, define and record useful vocabulary.	Question meaning and usage; reject decorative vocabulary students cannot explain.
54-59	Independent writing	Set: Why do people seek adventure? Require claim + explanation + example. Students write independently.	Produce one developed paragraph using precise vocabulary.	Baseline evidence for sentence control, explanation, spelling and punctuation.
59-60	Exit ticket	Prompt: Adventure is not simply ____; it is also ____ because ____.	Complete and submit before leaving.	Check whether students have moved beyond 'adventure = dangerous stuff'.

Questioning Ladder

1. Observe	What details immediately suggest adventure?
2. Infer	What idea about adventure is the opener trying to create?
3. Interpret	Why might people enjoy reading about adventures they would never attempt themselves?
4. Evaluate	Does an activity need to be dangerous to count as an adventure?
5. Challenge	If you know exactly what will happen, can it still be an adventure?

Board Plan & Vocabulary

LEFT: UNIT UNIT 1: In Search of Adventure Essential question: What drives people to seek out adventure?	CENTRE: WHY SEEK ADVENTURE? excitement • curiosity • challenge • achievement • escape • discovery • testing oneself • the unknown • recognition • self-knowledge	RIGHT: VOCABULARY risk • challenge • exploration • uncertainty • adversity • achievement • endure • overcome • venture • navigate • exhilarating • daunting • unpredictable
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Model Paragraph

People seek adventure because unfamiliar and challenging experiences can provide excitement and a sense of achievement. Ordinary life is usually predictable, whereas an adventure involves uncertainty and the possibility of something unexpected happening. Some people may therefore enjoy testing themselves against difficult situations. For example, a climber may value reaching a mountain summit partly because overcoming danger and exhaustion makes the achievement feel more significant.

Why it works: clear topic sentence • explanation • contrast • precise vocabulary • specific example • sustained focus on why.

Differentiation

SUPPORT	STRETCH
Speaking stems • I think an adventure needs... • People might seek adventure because... • The image suggests... because... • Conefrey believes... Writing stems • One reason people seek adventure is... • This is because... • For example... • Therefore...	Push conceptual distinctions: • adventure vs risk-taking • adventure vs exploration • bravery vs recklessness • physical vs intellectual adventure Challenge statement: "If you know exactly what will happen, it cannot be an adventure." Students decide how far they agree and justify their position.

Assessment for Learning

- During discussion: quality of inference, use of textual evidence, precision of vocabulary and ability to explain rather than list.
- Independent paragraph: use as baseline evidence for sentence control, paragraphing, vocabulary range, explanation, spelling and punctuation.
- Exit ticket: check whether students have developed a broader concept of adventure than simply physical danger.

EXIT TICKET

Adventure is not simply _____; it is also _____ because _____.

Homework / Optional Follow-up

Adventure Vocabulary Hunt: Find five words or phrases associated with adventure from a book, film, game, news story or other reading. For each word: (1) record it, (2) give its meaning, and (3) use it in an original sentence. The strongest choices are added to the class vocabulary wall.

Lesson Endpoint

Students should leave Lesson 1 with a broader, evidence-based conception of adventure and a useful bank of vocabulary. This prepares them for Lesson 2: The Hero's Journey, where the focus shifts from why people seek adventure to the recurring structure writers use to represent it.

Source basis: 6SI Unit 1 plan, Week 1 Lesson 1; Ignite English, Unit 1: In Search of Adventure, pp. 10-11. The lesson content and sequence are grounded in the uploaded unit plan and textbook pages.